ZED-UI

PROJECT ZOMBOID BUILD 42 — TOTAL UI OVERHAUL

v0.1.590604c — Session 59 — April 6, 2026

21	59	~190	21	21	9	14	~19k
DAYS	SESSIONS	HOURS	ATOMS	MOLECULES	ORGANISMS	FONTS	LINES

PHASE 1 — FOUNDATION

SESSIONS 1–4 · MAR 17–23

Design System Built

Tokens, Atoms, Molecules, Organisms coded. Hierarchical component library established.

SESSIONS 5–6 · MAR 24

Gallery + ScrollPanel

Sync-up, bug fixes, ScrollPanel created.

SESSION 7 · MAR 24–25

System 7.1 Chrome

Grow box, WindowShade, buttons, opacity. The chrome IS the design.

VISUAL FOUNDATION

PHASE 2 — ITEM CARD

SESSION 9 · MAR 25

ZeD_ItemCard — Live In-Game

10 category formatters, InspectHook, spec to screen in one session.

MAJOR MILESTONE

SESSIONS 10–11 · MAR 25

Design Audit + Action Strip

Zero hardcoded values. Toggle buttons (fav/protect/unwanted). M14 drawActionStrip.

SESSIONS 12–13 · MAR 26

Detail Zone + Dock Design

HTML mockup v10. Icon picker attempted, scrapped — UX needs rethink.

SESSIONS 14–16 · MAR 27–28

Docs, Docks, Zones

200+ vanilla source files cataloged. M15 drawDock. O09 ZoneList + M16 ZoneRow coded.

PHASE 3 — ARCHITECTURE REVOLUTION

SESSION 19 · MAR 29

Competitive Inventory Audit

22 confirmed UI patterns extracted from other games and mods.

SESSION 20 · MAR 29

Turducken — Inventory Absorbs Character

Inventory window IS the character window. Separate character info panel eliminated.

PARADIGM SHIFT

SESSION 21 · MAR 29

Two Windows To Rule Them All

Entire PZ UI collapses to Character Window + World Window. Tooltips eliminated. Drawer IS the detail surface. Full HUD = 4 draggable objects.

PARADIGM SHIFT

PHASE 4 — THE WALL + RECOVERY

SESSION 21.5 · MAR 29

From-Scratch Build

CharacterWindow.lua built fresh (~700 lines). Tab strip, drawer, item card all functioning.

SESSION 23 · MAR 30

Full Rewrite — Pulled Back

1950-line InventoryPane, pure ZeD atomics. Java UIManager pairing proved unbeatable. All overrides disabled, vanilla restored.

HARD LESSON — NEVER DERIVE FROM ISINVENTORYPAGE

SESSION 24 · MAR 31

ZeD_Panel — 5 Layers Proven

ISPanel:derive base class. Item list, scrolling, multi-select, column sorting, expand/collapse. All first-try clean. Zero errors.

INCREMENTAL PATH VALIDATED

SESSION 25 · MAR 31

Drag + Context + Character Window Shell

Ghost card drag with ISMouseDrag bridge. Context menu via vanilla ISInventoryPaneContextMenu. Character Window shell on ZeD_Window + ZeD_Panel (F7). Shared ZeD.InventoryRenderer module.

8 LAYERS

SESSION 26 · MAR 31

Tabs, Drawer, Containers, Responsive

Tab strip (28px, 7 tabs, 2 groups). Drawer state machine (item/tab modes, snap-back). Container strip (bag switching). Responsive ItemCard redesign. Progressive column collapse. Right-edge anchored layout.

11 LAYERS PROVEN

PHASE 5 — CHARACTER WINDOW COMPLETION

SESSION 27 · APR 1

Vanilla Keybind Takeover + Visibility Gate

I key opens ZeD window. Vanilla ISInventoryPage hidden. Prerender suppression. X-button close. Window resize. Container headers. ItemCard layout refinements.

17 LAYERS

SESSION 28 · APR 1

Health Tab + Font Overhaul + Title Bar Stats

Tab dispatch framework. Health data aggregation with severity badges. Font weights 500/500/700, accent subheadings, textDim split. Title bar heart + weight icons.

21 LAYERS

SESSION 29 · APR 1

Skills Tab + Per-Tab Drawer Width

2-column XP grid with category grouping, color-coded progress bars, level badges, boost pills. Per-tab drawer width system (480px for Skills). Generalized scroll dispatch. Light mode + large text scale fixes.

22 LAYERS

SESSION 30 · APR 1

BMFont Pipeline + Font Atomics + True Text Scaling

14 bitmap fonts (11–24px) across 4 HiDPI scales. ZeD.Font rich atomics {font, px}. T.scale factor. 3 text size presets (S/M/L). User-resizable inventory columns with drag dividers.

FONT SYSTEM COMPLETE

SESSION 31 · APR 2

ZoneList + Protection Tab + ItemCard Scroll

O09 ZeD_ZoneList organism. Protection tab (per-garment defense). ItemCard drawer scroll. Drawer width snap-back.

23 LAYERS

SESSION 32 · APR 2

Thermal Tab + Body Figure + New Atomics

7-view thermoregulation system. BodyFigure tile-grid rendering. drawGradientBar + drawStatBarRow atoms. Thermal spectrum tokens.

SESSIONS 33–34 · APR 2

Protection Tab Concept C — Dashboard + Drill-down

Brainstorm → spec → implementation. Body figure + letter grade + danger pills + garment drill-down. Progressive disclosure: 90% glance, 10% drill-down.

SESSION 35 · APR 2

Journal Tab + KillTracker

BBS-style diary with survival stats, expandable kill breakdown, inline text entry, game-world date stamping. Native kill categorization via PZ events.

SESSION 36 · APR 3

Training Materials — Skills Tab

CIO-style skill book catalog. 4-status system (read/reading/collected/missing). Expandable groups with chevron icons. Legend row. drawStatusDot atom.

SESSION 37 · APR 3

Cleanup + Comfy Pass + Contrast Audit + Footer Controls

wrapText consolidated. Comfy spacing tokens (afterLine/afterGroove). 18 theme-aware color tokens. Protection rework. Whole-tab scrolling. Footer theme buttons. Inventory scrollbar fixes. ~13,200 lines across 22 files.

QUALITY + ACCESSIBILITY PASS

SESSION 38 · APR 3

Identity Tab — KY License Card

KY driver's license card with bust portrait (ISUI3DModel click-to-expand), 10px bevel rounded corners, fixed KY color

palette, 2-col data grid, positive/negative traits grid.

SESSION 39 · APR 3

Journal Recipes + ID Polish + Tab Scroll

Recipe notebook (grouped by skill, known/unknown dots, expandable groups). ID card laminate border. Tab strip scroll arrows. All 7 character tabs complete.

SESSIONS 40–43 · APR 4

Health Figure + Audit + Click-to-Treat

Health body figure + dashboard + exercise buttons. Pre-world-window audit (pill/badge/swatch atoms). Click-to-treat via ISHealthPanel adapter. Pill button rounded corners.

SESSION 44 · APR 4

Multi-Container Accordion Columns

Container waterfall toggle, accordion columns in drawer space, XFER strip, cross-column drag-drop, item card coexistence. Character window feature complete.

CHARACTER WINDOW COMPLETE

SESSION 45 · APR 4

Audit Polish + Body Figure v2 + Container View Toggle

IdentityTab font tokens, shared figure dims, tab centering fixes. Body figure stacked-layer art with wireframe grid bg. _viewedContainer single-select on non-equip tabs.

PHASE 6 — WORLD WINDOW

SESSION 46 · APR 4

World Window Shell + Pinned Skills

ZeD_WorldWindow.lua from scratch. Container discovery (3x3 grid, wall/safehouse checks). Container strip. "I" keybind pairing. Pinned skills (max 2, FIFO, live XP in title bar).

SESSION 47 · APR 4

World Window Drawer + State Persistence

ItemCard drawer integration (260px slide animation). Window state persistence for both windows via ZeD_WinState modData. Two-page spread layout. Muscle strain detection in HealthTab.

SESSION 48 · APR 4

Action Tabs + MC Columns + Per-Window Accent + BG Unification

Action tab waterfall (L/C/B, right edge). Multi-container columns (click-to-toggle, XFER, drag-drop). Per-window accent colors. Body figure hover→white. Background unification (zero doubled fills). F-keys removed. Floor pinned active.

WORLD WINDOW FEATURE-RICH

SESSIONS 49–50 · APR 5

Crafting Tab — Voltron Rewrite

Complete CraftingTab.lua. Icon grid, Now Playing card, batch craft, search/filter/sort, pin strip (FIFO 8), OnGameStart pre-bake catalog. Material scanning with container throttle.

CRAFTING COMPLETE

SESSIONS 51–55 · APR 5–6

Accent Tinting + Floor Fix + Container Icons + Font Swap

Equipment tab (23 slots, list/card mode, body figure coverage). MC for all tabs. VT323 font. Arrow textures. Container icons. Crafting polish.

SESSIONS 56–58 · APR 6

Equipment Tab + Protection Merge + Font Overhaul

Protection tab merged into Equipment as collapsible DEFENSE dashboard (7→6 tabs). Geneva body font, Atkinson HL

Mono, dyslexic toggle. M.drawSectionHeader unified. Global spacing bump.

SESSION 59 · APR 6

Building Tab + Equipment Overhaul

Full BuildingTab.lua (tag categories, icon grid, BUILD placement cursor, pin strip). Equipment rows match inventory layout with protection columns (bite/scratch/bullet). WT sort in world container strip. RMB context-only. Equipped items hidden from inventory. Full atomics sweep.

BUILDING + EQUIPMENT

SESSION 60 · NEXT

Equipment Polish + Contextual Tabs

Bug testing, padding/layout work. Fishing/forage/animal contextual tabs, or cross-window drag-drop.

UP NEXT

FUTURE

CaZio Watch + HUD Elements

Watch system, minimap, moodle bar, standalone floaters.

FUTURE

Graphics + Icon Audit

poster.png, cursor set, gamepad badges. Purpose-built icons for all UI elements.

PHASE 7 — MAIN MENU SYSTEMS

FUTURE

CRT Main Menu

Retro CRT computer scene. ZeD-styled menu bar (File, Multiplayer, Settings). Room environment with desk objects, lamp, shelf, poster. Mockup: zed-main-menu-crt-v7_1.html.

FUTURE

Options Window

Unified settings: Display, Audio, Controls, Gameplay, Interface, Accessibility — all in ZeD_Window chrome. Searchable. Category sidebar. ZeD UI tab intercepts 12 vanilla settings.

FUTURE

Load Game + Mod Manager + New Game

Save browser with search + preview. Mod manager with available/active columns and drag reorder. New Game mode selector (Apocalypse, Sandbox, Challenges, etc.).

FUTURE

ZeD UI Settings + Accessibility Presets

Theme/accent/text size in dedicated tab. Colorblind modes (Protanopia, Deuteranopia, Tritanopia). Highlight color pickers. CaZio Watch config. One-click accessibility presets (Low Vision, Motor, Hearing).

PHASE 8 — POST-RELEASE / COMMUNITY-DRIVEN

Auto-Scale UI by Resolution

Detect screen resolution (4K/1440p/1080p), auto-select or multiply text scale preset. Infrastructure ready (T.scale, TextSizes). Needs playtest tuning across resolutions.

XL Text Scale Preset

Accessibility option. Code commented out in Tokens.lua, fonts already generated (20–24px). Uncomment if

community requests it.

DONE MAJOR MILESTONE HARD LESSON UP NEXT ○ HORIZON